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BRIDGE ON THE RIVER TAWI COLLAPSES

Vehicles remain stranded after the road near the fourth Tawi bridge was washed away due to swelling waterbodies following incessant heavy rainfall, in Jammu. Intense rains have lashed parts of India and Pakistan and triggered flash floods and landslides in Indian-administered Kashmir's Jammu region, leaving at least 34 people dead, officials said yesterday. Authorities in Pakistan's eastern Punjab province yesterday called for army assistance in rescue and relief efforts after torrential rains caused major rivers to swell, inundating villages and displacing more than 150,000 people, officials said.

SEE ALSO P11, 12

Mobile phones banned in public schools

Schools' failure to comply will constitute an administrative violation

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

The Ministry of Education has announced a ban on bringing mobile phones into school premises and, at the same time, established clear regulations for inspection and confiscation of phones found in students' possession. The decision aims to protect students from the

risks associated with carrying phones and to promote positive behaviour within a safe learning environment.

Regular inspections

According to the circular, schools are required to carry out regular inspection campaigns to detect mobile phones.

These inspections must comply with regulations and respect students' privacy. Inspectors are prohibited from physically touching students; searches are limited to their bags and personal belongings, with students themselves required to display their items before the inspection com-

mittee to ensure transparency and respect for rights.

The Ministry clarified that any phone found in a student's possession on school grounds will be confiscated in line with the Student Behaviour Management Regulation. Parents will be notified of the violation. The confiscation period is one month for the first offence; in case of repetition, the phone will be withheld until the end of the academic year.

The circular pointed out that failure by schools to comply with these instructions constitutes an administrative violation that may subject them to accountability.

SEE ALSO P2, 4

UAE among 40 nations on India outreach list

TRADE FAIRS, BUYER-SELLER MEETS, PROMOTIONAL CAMPAIGNS PLANNED

DUBAI
BY MANOJ NAIR
Business Editor

As part of the stepped-up drive to push exports amid the US tariff turmoil, India will launch outreach initiatives in 40 countries, including the UAE, and priority markets in Europe such as the UK, Spain, France, Germany, and Italy. These efforts will include trade fairs, buyer-seller meets, and sector-specific promotional campaigns, according to a senior Indian official.

Other nations include the Netherlands, Poland, Canada, Mexico, Russia, Belgium, Turkey and Australia.

India's merchandise exports are facing pressure amid geopolitical tensions and the 50 per cent punitive hike in US tariffs that kicked in yesterday.

UAE consultancies that advise on business set up and support services say that the number of enquiries from Indian businesses have definitely been higher after the Trump announcements.

Joint ventures

"After the first 25 per cent was revealed, many in India were still hopeful that this was a Trump negotiating tactic," said the CEO of a food processing unit in the UAE. "Then came the second 25 per cent and there seemed no move to reach a deal between the US

UAE consultancies that advise on business set up and support services say that the number of enquiries from Indian businesses have definitely been higher after the Trump announcements.

and India. That has got several Indian businesses with US exports talking to us about some sort of joint ventures or investments in the UAE."

The same talks are being heard in the UAE's jewellery trade, with more Indian companies looking to set up jewellery design and production centres here rather than have them ship out from India.

India's Commerce Ministry is set to hold a series of consultations with exporters this week as part of this renewed push to diversify India's export basket and strengthen its presence in global markets, a senior official confirmed. The meetings will bring together industry representatives from key sectors including textiles, chemicals and gems and jewellery, sources said.

The discussions are expected to centre around strategies to reduce dependence on a narrow set of products and markets, and to chart out a road map for entering new geographies. — with inputs from IANS

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